Start here

How this folder reads, how to answer, and how to bring your AI helper along

Read this one once. Every other proposal assumes you have.

Proposal 000 | Status evergreen | Updated 2026-10-29 | For the church's officers

TL;DR

> ***Tip Five lines, if that's all you read tonight.***
>
> 1. ***A proposal is one folder with one page.*** *The five-line TL;DR comes first, the detail folds away underneath, and the same page is rendered as a* ***PDF*** *in* `pdf/` *for anyone who would rather not open GitHub.*
> 2. ***Answering is short.*** *One line per question, in any order, in your own words. "Not sure" and "ask someone else" are good answers. Nothing changes until you answer.*
> 3. ***Bring your helper.*** *If you use ChatGPT, Claude or another assistant, three steps connect it to these pages so it can read, summarise and draft replies for you. The steps are on the foundation's members' page and below.*
> 4. ***The markdown travels with the PDF.*** *When a proposal is sent as a PDF, the* `.md` *goes with it, so a helper can read it word for word instead of guessing at a picture of a page.*
> 5. ***Nothing is published by a proposal.*** *A proposal asks. People decide. Here, the organisation's own officers and members decide; a proposal asks, people answer.*

How a proposal is shaped

Part	What it is for
TL;DR	five lines or fewer; if you read nothing else, read these
What and why	the idea in plain words, and the reason it is being raised now
Itinerary or at-a-glance table	the stops, each lighting up as it is done
Details	the technical material, folded into `<details open>` sections you can open or ignore
Decisions log	what was chosen, when, and why, so the reasoning is never lost
Asks	the questions that need a person, each with who can answer it
Sources	where every fact came from, with the date it was read

The icons beside each idea are a reading aid, not decoration: the same icon means the same thing on every page.

Status words

asking: we need your answer · **proposed**: written, waiting for a decision · **in progress**: agreed and under way · **done** · **idea**: not yet asked of anyone

How to answer

1. **Read the TL;DR.** If it is enough, answer from it.
2. **Answer in one line each**, in any order: "*F1 yes · F2 the second one · F3 not sure, ask Ash*".
3. **Send it the way you already talk to us:** a note to Christopher by your usual channel, or, if you have a reader's account, an **Issue** in the church's reading room (every reader can open one there; the `proposals` repository itself is for officers).
4. **Then the proposal changes, not before.** Your answers go into the decisions log with the date.

Bring your helper (three steps)

> ***Important Your AI helper can read these pages for you.*** *Any assistant that can connect to GitHub (ChatGPT, Claude, and others) can be pointed here, so it can summarise a proposal, explain a term, and help you answer in your own words.*
>
> 1. ***Connect it to GitHub.*** *In the assistant's apps or connectors list, connect **GitHub** and sign in with the account you use for the church. An owner may need to approve the helper and choose which repositories it may read. (How to join an organisation, who can read what.)*
> 2. ***Paste a first message:*** *"Read the organisation's ONBOARDING.md, then WELCOME-FOR-YOUR-HELPER.md. Tell me what you will do before you change anything."*
> 3. ***Ask in your own words.*** *Every change a helper proposes goes to a pull request that a person reviews. Nothing publishes itself.*

The members' page opens with the same three steps. If you would like a longer welcome written for your particular helper, ask, and one is written in the members' home beside the members' page.

The markdown beside the PDF

Every proposal exists twice: the `README.md` you are reading, and `pdf/NNN-name.pdf`, rendered from it. The PDF is for eyes; the markdown is for helpers. A helper given only a PDF has to rebuild the words from a picture of a page, and loses the links, the fold-away sections and the exact phrasing. So, whenever a proposal is sent on, **both files go**, and whenever one comes back to us, we ask for the markdown too. The full note: Markdown beside the PDF.

Five GitHub words, and no more

Word	Plain meaning
Repository (repo)	a folder with a memory: every change to every file, with who made it and when
Issue	a numbered conversation attached to a repo; the simplest way to answer or ask
Branch	a draft copy of the folder where work happens before anyone sees it on the main copy
Pull request	"*please look at this draft and, if you agree, make it the real one*"; a person reviews it
Commit	one saved step, with a sentence saying what changed and who did it

That is all a reader needs. Everything else is for the people who build.

Where things live

	Place	What it holds
	`psanctuarychurch/proposals` (members, signed in)	every proposal, numbered, with the index on its front page
	the reading room (members) · its public room (anyone)	the same proposals beside the church's procedures and decks; visitors see only what an officer has marked public
	github.com/psanctuarychurch (signed in)	the members' page, which opens with the three steps above
	the organisation's ONBOARDING.md	the welcome for people and helpers: who we are, what is private, how we work

Written for Psanctuary Church's members; a copy also stands in the public reading room · Icons: Lucide (ISC). This page is the pattern every organisation's proposals repo opens with; the template lives in my-template.